35 Tangkhul Proverbs & Idioms (Paocham)

Indigenous Oral Philosophy, Metaphorical Maxims & Cultural Wisdom

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[PAOCHAM-001] Ra-chay-li theingui-shai-lu, rit-linga-lung khang-san-lu, kachi katha.

Literal Meaning : Roasting fruit when thirsty, or putting a stone on an already heavy load.

English Meaning : Applies to a person who adds to his misery by repeated silly actions.

Hindi ??????? : ????? ???? ?? ?? ?????, ?? ???? ??? ?? ????? ?? ??? ????? (???? ?? ??????? ?? ???? ?????? ?????? / ??? ??? ?????)

Parallel Proverb: Adding fuel to fire / Adding insult to injury (Category: folklore & wisdom)

[PAOCHAM-002] Par-ki kaja-na shup-a, shup-ki kaja-na par-a, kachi katha.

Literal Meaning : Closing fist when one ought to open it, and opening when one ought to close.

English Meaning : Applies to an ambitious, greedy person who thinks he can get a lot for nothing.

Hindi ??????? : ?? ??? ????? ????? ?? ?????? ??????, ?? ?? ??? ???? ????? ?? ??? ????? (???? ??? ?? ??? ???? ????? / ???? ???? ??? ???)

Parallel Proverb: Covetousness over-reacheth itself (Category: greed & folly)

[PAOCHAM-003] Khamatha sa-gi ji-la fa nga-sa-thui-ho-wa, kachi katha.

Literal Meaning : Intending to do something good, but turning it into a complete mess.

English Meaning : Applies to one who is unfortunate in any attempt to do something good.

Hindi ??????? : ????? ???? ??? ?? ?? ??? ?? ????? ???? (???? ?? ?? ?? ????? ????, ???? ?? ?? ???)

Parallel Proverb: The road to hell is paved with good intentions (Category: experience)

[PAOCHAM-004] Nga-ley-a-kha shi-ley-tha, nga-yur-a-kha nga-wur tha, yay-a-kha nga-yay tha, kachi katha.

Literal Meaning : Unity is like wasps' nest on rock; discord is like moles' nest; shallowness is like a sieve.

English Meaning : United we stand strong as a rock; divided we collapse like dry loam.

Hindi ??????? : ???? ?????? ?? ??? ?????? ?? ????? ???? ???? ???? ??; ??? ????? ?? ?? ?????? ?? ??? ???? ?? ???? ???

Parallel Proverb: United we stand, divided we fall (Category: kinship & unity)

[PAOCHAM-005] Tho-rachi-than thri, thai-ra chi-than tho, kachi katha.

Literal Meaning : Expecting feast and starving; expecting nothing and finding abundance.

English Meaning : Receiving unexpected fortune when least expected, and disappointed when expectant.

Hindi ??????? : ?? ???? ?????? ?? ?? ???? ???, ?? ?? ??? ?? ? ?? ?? ????? ???? ?? ?????

Parallel Proverb: Blessed are they that expect nothing, for they shall not be disappointed (Category: fortune & expectation)

[PAOCHAM-006] Mei kachot-li tara phungda kazat, kachi katha.

Literal Meaning : Carrying cold water while running towards a raging wild forest fire.

English Meaning : Coming well-prepared with peace when tempers flare in clan gatherings.

Hindi ??????? : ???? ?? ?? ?????? ?? ??? ???? ???? ???? ??????? (????? ??? ????? ?? ???? ??????)

Parallel Proverb: A soft answer turneth away wrath (Category: peace & conciliation)

[PAOCHAM-007] Lung-kui eina tonda kazat kha pheikhavai makalei, kachi katha.
Literal Meaning : Gliding down steep crags like river eel without arms or feet.
English Meaning : Overcoming insurmountable natural obstacles through quiet perseverance and adaptability.
Hindi ??????? : ???? ???-??? ?? ?? ???? ????? ??? ???????? ?? ???????? ???? ????? (????? ?? ?????? ?? ?? ???? ??? ?????)
Parallel Proverb: Where there is a will, there is a way (Category: perseverance)

[PAOCHAM-008] Kaphung terrace-li yarshon-sakashung kha phei eina khon masamana.
Literal Meaning : Bowing low across terrace fields from dawn to dusk without complaining.
English Meaning : Tireless diligence and quiet hard work bringing forth abundant harvest.
Hindi ??????? : ???????? ????? ??? ??? ?? ??? ?? ???? ?? ??? ????? ????? (??????? ?? ????? ?? ????? ???)
Parallel Proverb: Hard work never kills a man / Diligence is the mother of good luck (Category: labor & agriculture)

[PAOCHAM-009] Khamang-tui ror-a-kha lungli chei-thada kapam, kachi katha.
Literal Meaning : A solemn promise once carved stands firmer than iron in mountain granite.
English Meaning : A man of true honor never breaks his sworn word.
Hindi ??????? : ???? ?? ????? ??? ????? ?? ???? ???? ??? (????? ??? ?? ??? ? ????)
Parallel Proverb: An honest man's word is as good as his bond (Category: honor & integrity)

[PAOCHAM-010] Ngashunli khangapa, ngaya tharan meira phungkazat, kachi katha.
Literal Meaning : Resting quietly by day, glowing brightly when darkness falls over the ridge.
English Meaning : A humble and modest person whose true brilliance shines in times of crisis.
Hindi ??????? : ??? ??? ???? ???? ??????? ?? ??? ??? ???? ???? ?????? (???? ??? ?? ????? ??? ?? ????? ???? ???)
Parallel Proverb: Adversity introduces a man to himself (Category: modesty & courage)

[PAOCHAM-011] Maza khamahon tharan samkui eina phei mashun, kachi katha.
Literal Meaning : Striking the wooden mortar with rhythmic precision when golden paddy is ripe.
English Meaning : Seizing the opportune moment when circumstances are ripe for harvest.
Hindi ??????? : ??? ???? ?? ??? ??? ??? ???? ?????? (???? ?? ??? ????? / ???? ?? ???? ??????)
Parallel Proverb: Strike while the iron is hot (Category: opportunity)

[PAOCHAM-012] Ava-wui ning eina tara kaphung thada ngakhum, kachi katha.
Literal Meaning : A mother's heart is a deep spring that never dries through summer drought.
English Meaning : Unconditional motherly love and boundless familial devotion.
Hindi ??????? : ??? ?? ????? ?? ???? ????? ???? ?? ?? ??? ?? ?????? ??? ?? ??? ???? ??????
Parallel Proverb: A mother's love is peace / Blood is thicker than water (Category: kinship & devotion)

[PAOCHAM-013] Minao-na kaphungli zat-la thing-kuisam ma-khat-mana, kachi katha.

Literal Meaning : Walking through high pine woods without disturbing dry fallen needles.
English Meaning : Living so harmoniously and respectfully with nature that no harm is left behind.
Hindi ??????? : ???? ?? ???? ?? ?? ??? ??????? ?? ???? ????? ?? ? ????? (??????? ?? ??? ????? ?????????)
Parallel Proverb: Leave nothing but footprints, take nothing but memories (Category: ecology & nature)

[PAOCHAM-014] Sira kachangli khayang-eili phei khurli ngatak, kachi katha.

Literal Meaning : Gazing at the distant stars while stepping blind into the muddy ditch.
English Meaning : Being so preoccupied with lofty daydreams that one forgets immediate duties.
Hindi ??????? : ????? ?? ???? ?????-????? ????? ?? ???? ?? ????? ??? ??? ????? (???? ???? ??????)
Parallel Proverb: Keep your feet on the ground and your eyes on the stars (Category: folly & distraction)

[PAOCHAM-015] Khamiyang-wui hamli tara kachui ma-tam-mana, kachi katha.

Literal Meaning : The guest pot in a hospitable home is never dry when a stranger knocks.
English Meaning : Generous hospitality is the crown jewel of Tangkhul village character.
Hindi ??????? : ?????-?????? ???? ???? ?? ?? ?? ????? ??? ???? ???? ????? (????? ???? ???)
Parallel Proverb: Hospitality makes all men kin (Category: hospitality)

[PAOCHAM-016] Khara-ngashat kakhon eina lami y?m-thui-haowa, kachi katha.

Literal Meaning : The single sharp bark of the deer causes the lurking leopard to flee.
English Meaning : Timely warning from the alert saves the entire community from disaster.
Hindi ??????? : ????? ?? ?? ???? ????? ?? ??? ???? ?????? ?? ????? ????? ??? (??? ?? ?? ?? ??????? ??? ????? ???)
Parallel Proverb: Forewarned is forearmed (Category: vigilance)

[PAOCHAM-017] Wung-wui akhonli ngaka kha mashunli zang-ra, kachi katha.

Literal Meaning : Heeding the quiet counsel of village elders keeps one upon the safe mountain trail.
English Meaning : Respect for ancestral wisdom safeguards the youth from cliffside ruin.
Hindi ??????? : ????????? ?? ??? ????? ???? ?? ?????? ??????? ?? ??? ??? ???? ???????
Parallel Proverb: Listen to the elders, for they have traveled the road (Category: wisdom & elders)

[PAOCHAM-018] Fa-kharar-na ngaya rurung-eili chimik kakhaya mathei, kachi katha.

Literal Meaning : The aged hound dozes by the fire, yet hears the softest tread in the yard.
English Meaning : Old age brings sharpened inner perception and quiet intuition.
Hindi ??????? : ????? ?????? ?????? ?? ??? ???? ????? ??, ?? ???? ?? ?????? ??? ?? ??? ???? ???
Parallel Proverb: There is no fool like an old fool / Experience is the best teacher (Category: intuition & age)

[PAOCHAM-019] Khong-kharar kakhong tharan mayarnao saikora ngasot-ser-re, kachi katha.
Literal Meaning : When the great village log drum sounds, all men stand together as one wall.
English Meaning : In times of collective defense, internal bickering vanishes instantly.
Hindi ??????? : ?? ???? ?? ???-?????? ???? ??, ?? ?? ????? ????? ?? ????? ?? ???? ????
Parallel Proverb: A common danger unites even foes (Category: solidarity)

[PAOCHAM-020] Shongfa kharar-li kazat-a-kha aphei ma-chot-mana, kachi katha.
Literal Meaning : Walking along the ancient beaten footpath ensures sure feet that never stumble.
English Meaning : Adhering to proven tradition brings security and peace of mind.
Hindi ??????? : ?????? ?? ??? ?????? ?? ???? ?? ???? ??? ??? ????? ???? ??????
Parallel Proverb: Do not leave the old road for a new one (Category: tradition)

[PAOCHAM-021] Rap-kaphungli meikha kashur-thada ning kacham ngachon-ra, kachi katha.
Literal Meaning : Like smoked venison cured above the hearth, patience sweetens character.
English Meaning : Trials endured with patience temper human character into pure gold.
Hindi ??????? : ???? ???? ?? ???? ??? ???? ???? ????? ???? ??, ???? ?? ????? ?? ????? ??????? ???? ???
Parallel Proverb: Patience is bitter, but its fruit is sweet (Category: patience)

[PAOCHAM-022] Tangkhul-tui eina laa kasa-kha kaphung chiko ngakhum-ra, kachi katha.
Literal Meaning : Singing in ancestral Tangkhul tongue echoes across nine mountain ridges.
English Meaning : Preserving one's native language preserves the very soul of the ancestors.
Hindi ??????? : ???????? ?????? ??? ???? ??? ???-??? ?? ????????? ?? ??? ?? ?????? ???
Parallel Proverb: A language is the soul of its people (Category: language & identity)

[PAOCHAM-023] Zimik kashung-tharan kachon phunglu, ngazing tharan chabi thumlu, kachi katha.
Literal Meaning : Work while the sun blazes high; lock the gate securely when dusk falls.
English Meaning : Do all things in their proper season and balance labor with domestic rest.
Hindi ??????? : ??? ???? ????? ???, ?? ??? ???? ?? ?? ?? ?????? ????? (??? ?? ??? ?? ??? ?? ????????)
Parallel Proverb: Make hay while the sun shines (Category: discipline)

[PAOCHAM-024] Meikhu makalei-eili meira ma-ngaphar-mana, kachi katha.
Literal Meaning : Where there is no smoke rising, there can be no crackling campfire.
English Meaning : Rumors rarely originate without some core grain of truth.
Hindi ??????? : ???? ???? ????, ???? ?? ???? ?? ????? (???? ?? ?? ???? ???? ?????)
Parallel Proverb: Where there's smoke, there's fire (Category: truth & observation)

[PAOCHAM-025] Kharai-kanao-li lungkui khangsan-a-kha kachir kakhai-ra, kachi katha.

Literal Meaning : Packing heavy river stones into a tiny cane basket breaks the bottom through.
English Meaning : Imposing unbearable responsibilities upon the young or weak causes ruin.
Hindi ??????? : ????? ????? ??? ???? ????? ????? ?? ???? ??? ?? ???? ??? (?????? ?? ???? ??? ? ?????)
Parallel Proverb: The last straw breaks the camel's back (Category: moderation)

[PAOCHAM-026] Hamei makalei-eili khor-tara ma-nganam-mana, kachi katha.

Literal Meaning : Without yeast cake, boiled rice can never turn into fragrant wine.
English Meaning : Great accomplishments require the catalytic spark of inspiration and effort.
Hindi ??????? : ???? ???? ?? ???? ??? ???? ????? ??? ???? ??? ????? (???? ??????? ?? ?????? ?? ?????? ?????)
Parallel Proverb: No pain, no gain (Category: effort & transformation)

[PAOCHAM-027] Pui-kashao eina lung-phei chathat-a-kha pui kakhai-ra, kachi katha.

Literal Meaning : Striking sharp cliff rocks with flexible green bamboo snaps the cane in two.
English Meaning : Trying to defeat rigid malice with rash anger harms oneself alone.
Hindi ??????? : ????? ?? ???? ?? ???? ??? ?? ????? ?? ???? ?? ????? ??? (????? ??? ???? ?? ?????? ???? ???)
Parallel Proverb: He who spits against the wind spits in his own face (Category: prudence)

[PAOCHAM-028] Shim-wui yumshang kaphung-thada amei-ngasot-na shim khavai lei, kachi katha.

Literal Meaning : Like the central house pillar holds the roof, loving brotherhood sustains the clan.
English Meaning : Mutual trust between brothers is the unbreakable support of the family.
Hindi ??????? : ???? ?? ?? ????? ???? ????? ????? ??, ???? ?? ?????? ?? ????? ?????? ?? ????? ???? ???
Parallel Proverb: A brother is a friend given by nature (Category: brotherhood & family)

[PAOCHAM-029] Tara-shongfa-li khangao-eili khorum makalei, kachi katha.

Literal Meaning : Drawing water at the living spring leaves no mud inside the drinking cup.
English Meaning : Seeking knowledge directly from original ancestral sources keeps the mind clear.
Hindi ??????? : ????? ???? ???? ?? ???? ???? ?? ?????? ??? ??? ????? ???? ???? (??? ??????? ?? ????? ?????)
Parallel Proverb: Drink from the spring, not the ditch (Category: knowledge & clarity)

[PAOCHAM-030] Shirui-wui kashong won-thada kaph?-bing-na kuiphungli ph?-ra, kachi katha.

Literal Meaning : Like the Shirui Lily blooming on the summit, genuine virtue cannot be hidden in shadow.
English Meaning : True noble character is recognized and celebrated far and wide.
Hindi ??????? : ????? ????? ?? ?????? ??? ?? ???, ????? ?????? ??? ?????? ??? ???? ??????
Parallel Proverb: A good name is better than precious ointment (Category: virtue & renown)

[PAOCHAM-031] Chumpha tharan shimkhur khong-eili maza-wui ngachee kathei, kachi katha.

Literal Meaning : When opening the granary at Chumpha, the harvest tells the truth of the year's toil.
English Meaning : Ultimate results reveal the true quality of past labor and preparation.
Hindi ??????? : ???? ?? ??? ?? ????-????? ????? ??, ?? ??? ?? ?? ????? ?? ?? ????? ??? ???
Parallel Proverb: By their fruits ye shall know them (Category: harvest & reward)

[PAOCHAM-032] Lami-kanao-na kuisam ngaphar-la hok-kharam ma-ngachee-mana, kachi katha.

Literal Meaning : A small wildcat spitting fire cannot intimidate a tusker boar.
English Meaning : Empty bluster and hollow boasts collapse before genuine strength.
Hindi ??????? : ???? ?????? ?? ???????? ?? ????? ???? ??? ????? ???? ????? (????? ???? ?? ??? ???? ?????)
Parallel Proverb: Barking dogs seldom bite (Category: courage vs boast)

[PAOCHAM-033] Thingrong kaphung-wui tarep-thada okathuili thot-thotli mashang, kachi katha.

Literal Meaning : Like deep roots of an ancient banyan holding terrace slopes through centuries.
English Meaning : Deep ancestral cultural roots keep a people standing through all historic storms.
Hindi ??????? : ????? ??????? ?? ???? ????? ?? ???, ?? ??????? ??? ?? ???? ?? ???? ???? ????
Parallel Proverb: A tree with strong roots laughs at storms (Category: heritage & endurance)

[PAOCHAM-034] Amai mashun-eili khon kashok marang, kachi katha.

Literal Meaning : The straight wooden hoe cuts clean without clattering noise.
English Meaning : A truly competent craftsman works quietly without bragging.
Hindi ??????? : ???? ????? ?????? ???? ??? ???? ??? ??? ???? ??? (????? ??????? ??? ???? ?????? ??, ????? ?????)
Parallel Proverb: Still waters run deep / Actions speak louder than words (Category: humility & craft)

[PAOCHAM-035] Tangkhul Ram-wui lung-kharar-thada phaning-kacham ngaror-ra, kachi katha.

Literal Meaning : Standing as unyielding as the sacred standing stones of our Tangkhul homeland.
English Meaning : Uncompromising loyalty to land, people, and truth through all eternity.
Hindi ??????? : ?????? ???????? ?? ?????? ??????-??????? ?? ??? ???? ?? ????????? ?? ???? ?????
Parallel Proverb: Firm as a rock in the midst of the sea (Category: patriotism & honor)